China	India
2 episodes of successful peace-making for IRI, 1988 & 2014	No history of major security cooperation with IRI
Share anti-US worldview w/IRI leadership	Views US role in Asia much more positively than IRI does
Key partner in region = Pakistan, *not* hostile to US	Key partner in region = Iran, hostile relations w/US
Leverage with Pakistan	Convergent views w/Iran re Taliban & Pakistan role
Deep pockets & ability complete projects on time	Thin foreign currency reserves and lethargic bureaucracy
Security Council permanent membership = leverage	No Security Council permanent membership
IRI's key nuclear partner prior to 1997	No connection to IRI nuclear program
Ancient civilization kinship	Ancient civilization kinship

FIGURE 6.2 Advantages in India-China Contest for Iran
Source: Author

Structural factors seem to be driving the emerging China–India rivalry toward Iran. First, the withdrawal of US power during Obama's second administration (2012–2016 and culminating in the JCPOA) greatly reduced the danger to China and India of cooperation with Iran. This opened the door to vigorous Chinese and Indian search for cooperation with Iran. During the immediate post-Soviet period, the United States used its immense strength to limit the relations of both China and India with Tehran. Once the United States relaxed this effort, Beijing and New Delhi moved quickly to expand cooperation with the IRI. Rather like the United States opening to China in mid-1971 led to an avalanche of support in the General Assembly for PRC admission, Washington's 2015 deal with Tehran opened the